

Niqqud Sound-by-Sound Reference



Every niqqud symbol grouped by the sound it makes, including the yud variants and the trickier double-duty symbols (kamatz gadol/katan).

The "ah" and "eye" sound

Sound	Patach	Patach yud	Hataf patach	Kamatz*	Kamatz yud
AH	אָ		אֲ	אִ	
EYE		אֵ			אֵי

* Kamatz uses the identical symbol as kamatz katan, which makes an "o" sound in certain unstressed, closed syllables (see the "o" table below).

The "eh" sound

Sound	Segol	Hataf segol
EH	אֶ	אִי

The "ei" sound (often flattened to "eh" in modern speech)

Sound	Tzere	Tzere malei
EI	אִי	אֵי

The "ee" sound

Sound	Hirik	Hirik yud
EE	אִי	אֵי

The "o" and "oy" sound

Sound	Holam	Holam malei	Holam yud	Hataf kamatz	Kamatz katan*
O	אֹ	אִי		אִי	אִי
OY			אִי		

* Kamatz katan uses the identical symbol as kamatz gadol (the "ah" sound above) — there's no visual difference between them. Which sound it makes depends on the syllable, not the mark itself.

The "oo" and "ooee" sound

Sound	Kubutz	Shuruk	Shuruk yud
OO	אֻ	אִי	
OOEE			אִי

Shva (silent or a light "uh")

Sound	Shva
— / uh	אֱ